Keyboard Songbook

Beginner Grade 1 • 15 songs with chords, notes, finger numbers and words

How to read each line

Chord	Left hand. Play it at the start of the group and hold it.
Notes	Right hand melody.
Fingers	1 = thumb, 2 = index, 3 = middle, 4 = ring, 5 = little finger.
Words	Sing one syllable per note.

Example:

C	**C**	**F**	**C**
C C	**G G**	**A A**	**G**
1 1	4 4	5 5	4
Twin-kle,	*twin-kle,*	*lit-tle*	*star,*

X = hold the note before it. **+C, +G** = the higher C or G. **G7 → C** = change chord inside the group.

Left-hand chord shapes

Chord	Keys	Fingers
C	C + E + G	5, 3, 1
F	C + F + A	5, 2, 1
G (with C songs)	B + D + G	5, 3, 1
G7	B + F + G	5, 2, 1
G (with G songs)	G + B + D	5, 3, 1
C (with G songs)	G + C + E	5, 2, 1
D	F# + A + D	5, 2, 1
D7	F# + A + C or C + D + F#	5, 2, 1 or 5, 4, 1

Songs

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01. Twinkle Twinkle Little Star

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, F, G**

C **C C** 1 1 *Twin-kle,*	**C** **G G** 4 4 *twin-kle,*	**F** **A A** 5 5 *lit-tle*	**C** **G** 4 *star,*
F **F F** 4 4 *How I*	**C** **E E** 3 3 *won-der*	**G** **D D** 2 2 *what you*	**C** **C** 1 *are!*
C **C C** 1 1 *Twin-kle,*	**C** **G G** 4 4 *twin-kle,*	**F** **A A** 5 5 *lit-tle*	**C** **G** 4 *star,*
F **F F** 4 4 *How I*	**C** **E E** 3 3 *won-der*	**G** **D D** 2 2 *what you*	**C** **C** 1 *are!*
C **G G** 5 5 *Up a-*	**F** **F F** 4 4 *bove the*	**C** **E E** 3 3 *world so*	**G** **D** 2 *high,*
C **G G** 5 5 *Like a*	**F** **F F** 4 4 *dia-mond*	**C** **E E** 3 3 *in the*	**G** **D** 2 *sky.*
C **C C** 1 1 *Twin-kle,*	**C** **G G** 4 4 *twin-kle,*	**F** **A A** 5 5 *lit-tle*	**C** **G** 4 *star,*
F **F F** 4 4 *How I*	**C** **E E** 3 3 *won-der*	**G** **D D** 2 2 *what you*	**C** **C** 1 *are!*

- *Each chord lasts for one pair of notes.*

02. Mary Had a Little Lamb

Key: **G major** | Chords: **G, D (or D7)**

G **B A G A** 3 2 1 2 *Ma-ry had a*	**G** **B B B X** 3 3 3 *lit-tle lamb,*	**D** **A A A X** 2 2 2 *lit-tle lamb,*	**G** **B D D X** 3 5 5 *lit-tle lamb,*

G	G	D7	G
B A G A	B B B B	A A B A	G X X X
3 2 1 2	3 3 3 3	2 2 3 2	1
Ma-ry had a	*lit-tle lamb, its*	*fleece was white as*	*snow.*

- *D7 on "fleece was white as" gives a stronger pull into the final G.*

03. London Bridge

Key: **G major** | Chords: **G, D7**

G	G
D E D C	B C D X
4 5 4 3	2 3 4
Lon-don Bridge is	*fall-ing down,*

D7	G
A B C X	B C D X
1 2 3	2 3 4
fall-ing down,	*fall-ing down,*

G	G
B A G A	B B B B
3 2 1 2	3 3 3 3

D7	G
A A B A	G X X X
2 2 3 2	1

Usual ending (to sing with the words)

G	G	D7	G
D E D C	B C D X	A D	B G
Lon-don Bridge is	*fall-ing down,*	*my fair*	*la-dy.*

- *Lines 3 and 4 in the book use the same notes as the ending of Mary Had a Little Lamb, so the words don't fit them. Use the usual ending below to sing the song.*

04. God is so Good

Key: **G major** | Chords: **G, C, D, D7**

G	G	D
G	G B	A
1	1 3	2
God	*is so*	*good,*

D7	D7	G
A	A C	B
2	2 4	3
God	*is so*	*good,*

G	G	C	D7	G	D7	G
B	B D	C	A C	B	A	G
3	3 5	4	2 4	3	2	1
God	*is so*	*good,*	*He's so*	*good*	*to*	*me.*

- *On "to me", play D7 on "to" and change to G on "me".*

05. Baa Baa Black Sheep

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, F, G, G7**

C	C	F	C
C C	G G	A B C A	G
1 1	2 2	3 4 5 3	2
Baa, baa,	*black sheep,*	*have you a-ny*	*wool?*

F	C	G	C
F F	E E	D D D	C
4 4	3 3	2 2 2	1
Yes sir,	*yes sir,*	*three bags*	*full.*

C	C	F	C	G
G	G G	F F	E E E	D
5	5 5	4 4	3 3 3	2
One	*for the*	*mas-ter,*	*one for the*	*dame,*

C	C	F	G7	C	G	C
G	G G	F G A	F	E	D D	C
5	5 5	3 4 5	4	3	2 2	1
One	*for the*	*lit-tle boy*	*who*	*lives*	*down the*	*lane.*

- *Same melody family as Twinkle Twinkle, so the chord pattern feels familiar.*

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06. Happy Birthday to You

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, F, G7**

C	G7
G G A G	C B
1 1 2 1	4 3
Hap-py birth-day	*to you,*

G7	C
G G A G	D C
1 1 2 1	5 4
Hap-py birth-day	*to you,*

C	C	C	F
G G	+G E	C	B A
1 1	5 4	3	2 1
Hap-py	*birth-day*	*dear*	*(Name),*

C	C	G7	C
E F E	C	D	C
3 4 3	1	2	1
Hap-py birth-	*day*	*to*	*you!*

- *+G in line 3 is the higher G: the big jump of the song.*
- *The usual tune starts the last line with F F E. If you play it that way, use F on "Hap-py".*

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07. Jesus Loves Me

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, F, G, G7**

Verse

C	C
G E E D	E G G X
5 3 3 2	3 5 5
Je-sus loves me,	*this I know,*

F	C
A A C A	A G G X
2 2 4 2	2 1 1
For the Bi-ble	*tells me so.*

C	C
G E E D	E G G X
5 3 3 2	3 5 5
Lit-tle ones to	*Him be-long,*

F	G7	C
A G E C	E D	C X
5 4 3 1	3 2	1
They are weak, but	*He is*	*strong.*

Chorus

C	F
G X E G	A C X X
5 3 5	2 4
Yes, Je-sus	*loves me,*

C	G
G X E C	E D X X
5 3 1	3 2
Yes, Je-sus	*loves me,*

C	F
G X E G	A C X A
5 3 5	2 4 5
Yes, Je-sus	*loves me, the*

C	G7	C
G C E	D	C X X X
4 1 3	2	1
Bi-ble tells	*me*	*so.*

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08. Old MacDonald

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, F, G7**

C	F	C	C	G7	C
C C C G	A A	G	E E	D D	C
3 3 3 1	2 2	1	5 5	2 2	1
Old Mac-Don-ald	*had a*	*farm,*	*E-I-*	*E-I-*	*O!*

C		F	C
G C C C G		A A	G
1 3 3 3 1		2 2	1
And on that farm he		*had a*	*cow,*

C	G7	C
E E	D D	C
3 3	2 2	1
E-I-	*E-I-*	*O!*

C

G C C C G C C C C C

1 3 3 3 1 3 3 3 3 3

With a moo-moo here, and a moo-moo there,

C

C C C C C C C C C

3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3

Here a moo, there a moo, ev-ery-where a moo-moo,

C	F	C	C	G7	C
C C C G	A A	G	E E	D D	C
3 3 3 1	2 2	1	3 3	2 2	1
Old Mac-Don-ald	*had a*	*farm,*	*E-I-*	*E-I-*	*O!*

> • *Lines 4 and 5 have fewer notes than words: sing quick words like "with a" and "and a" together on one note. Hold C in the left hand for both lines.*

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09. Wheels on the Bus

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, G7** | Notes from the book, with new practice words

C

G C C C C E

1 3 3 3 3 5

Let's all play the key-board,

C	G7	G7
G E C	D D D	B A G
5 3 1	2 2 2	3 2 1
Thumb is one,	*pin-ky's five,*	*here we go!*

C

G C C C C E

1 3 3 3 3 5

Fin-gers on the key-board,

C	G7	G7	C
G E C	D D	G G	C C C
5 3 1	2 2	1 1	3 3 3
Up and down	*the keys*	*we play*	*all day long!*

> • *These are original practice words that fit the notes one syllable per note. Students who know the traditional words can sing those with the same notes and chords.*

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10. Bits of Paper

Key: **G major** | Chords: **G, D7** | Notes from the book, with new practice words

G	G
B C D G	B C D G
2 3 4 1	2 3 4 1
Clap your hands now,	*clap your hands now,*
G	**G**
B C B C D	B C B C D
2 3 2 3 4	2 3 2 3 4
Sing a hap-py song,	*sing a hap-py song,*

D7	G	D7	G
D E D C	B G	D E D C	B G
4 5 4 3	3 1	4 5 4 3	3 1
Mu-sic makes us	*hap-py,*	*mu-sic makes us*	*hap-py,*

D7	G	D7	G
A D	G	A D	G
4 1	2	4 1	2
Play a-	*long,*	*play a-*	*long!*

- *Original practice words, one syllable per note. The traditional words can be sung with the same notes and chords.*

11. Row Row Row Your Boat

Key: **G major** | Chords: **G, D7**

G	G
G G G A B	G G G A B
1 1 1 2 3	1 1 1 2 3
Row, row, row your boat,	*Row, row, row your boat,*
G	**G**
B A B C D	B A B C D
3 2 3 4 5	3 2 3 4 5
Gent-ly down the stream,	*Gent-ly down the stream,*

G
G G D D B B G
5 5 3 3 2 2 1
Mer-ri-ly, mer-ri-ly,

G
G G D D B B G
5 5 3 3 2 2 1
Mer-ri-ly, mer-ri-ly,

D7	G	D7	G
D C B A	G	D C B A	G
5 4 3 2	1	5 4 3 2	1
Life is but a	*dream,*	*Life is but a*	*dream.*

- *For a little more colour, play D instead of G on the word "stream".*

12. Jingle Bells (Half Version)

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, F, D7, G, G7**

C	C	C	C
E E E	E E E	E G C D	E
3 3 3	3 3 3	3 5 1 2	3
Jin-gle bells,	*jin-gle bells,*	*jin-gle all the*	*way!*

F	C	D7	G
F F F F	F E E E	D D D E	D G
4 4 4 4	4 3 3 3	2 2 2 3	2 5
Oh what fun it	*is to ride in*	*a one-horse o-*	*pen sleigh!*

C	C	C	C
E E E	E E E	E G C D	E
3 3 3	3 3 3	3 5 1 2	3
Jin-gle bells,	*jin-gle bells,*	*jin-gle all the*	*way!*

F	C	G7	C
F F F F	F E E E	G G E D	C
4 4 4 4	4 3 3 3	5 5 3 2	1
Oh what fun it	*is to ride in*	*a one-horse o-pen*	*sleigh!*

> • *Line 2 ends on D7 to G, which leaves the music hanging. Line 4 ends on G7 to C, which closes the song.*

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13. National Anthem: Jana Gana Mana (Full)

Key: **C (ends on F)** | Chords: **C, F, G, G7, D7**

First half (from the book)

C	G7
C D E E E E E E E E E	D E F
1 2 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3 3	2 3 4

Jana gana mana adhinayaka jaya he

C	G	G7	C
E E E	D D D	B D	C
3 3 3	2 2 2	1 3	2

Bharata bhagya vidhata

C	D7 → G	D7 → G
C G G G G G G G	G F# G	A G
1 4 4 4 4 4 4 4	4 3 4	5 4

Panjaba Sindhu Gujarata Maratha

F	C	G7 → C	C	G
F F F F F	E	D F E	E E E E	E D
4 4 4 4 4	3	2 4 3	3 3 3 3	3 2

Dravida Utkala Banga, Vindhya Himachala

C	F	C	G	G7	C
G G G	F F	E E E	D D D	B D	C
5 5 5	4 4	3 3 3	2 2 2	1 3	2

Yamuna Ganga, Uchchhala jaladhi taranga

Second half

C	G7
C D E E E E	D E F

Tava shubha name jage,

C	G7 → C
E F G G G	F E D F E

Tava shubha ashisha mage,

C	G	G7 → C
E E D D	D D	B D C

Gahe tava jaya gatha.

C	D7 → G
G G G G G G G G G G	F# A G

Jana gana mangala dayaka jaya he

F	C	G7 → C
F F F F F	E	D F E

Bharata bhagya vidhata.

G → C	G	F
B B +C	B A B	A G A

Jaya he, jaya he, jaya he,

C	C	F
C C D D	E E D E	F

Jaya jaya jaya jaya he!

- *Lyrics: Rabindranath Tagore. Words are shown under each line; a few syllables stretch across two notes.*
- *+C is the higher C. The anthem ends on F, so finish on an F chord.*
- *The book has the first half only (with finger numbers). Second-half notes are adapted from a published beginner melody (piano-keyboard-guide.com), moved from D down to C to match the book.*
- *Keep the left hand soft and steady so the melody stays clearly on top. The full anthem takes about 52 seconds.*

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14. Yankee Doodle

Key: **G major** | Chords: **G, C, D, D7**

G	G → D
G G A B	G B A
1 1 2 3	1 3 2
Yan-kee Doo-dle	*went to town,*

G	D7
G G A B	G F#
1 1 2 3	2 1
Rid-ing on a	*po-ny,*

G	C
G G A B	C B A E
1 1 2 3	5 4 3 1
Stuck a fea-ther	*in his cap and*

D7	G
D D E F#	**G G**
2 2 3 4	5 5
called it mac-a-	*ro-ni.*

- *"G → D" means start on G and change to D on the last note ("town").*

15. Lightly Row

Key: **C major** | Chords: **C, G7**

C	G7	C	C
G E E	**F D D**	**C D E F**	**G G G**
5 3 3	4 2 2	1 2 3 4	5 5 5
Light-ly row,	*light-ly row,*	*o'er the glass-y*	*waves we go;*

C	G7	C	C
G E E	**F D D**	**C E G G**	**E**
5 3 3	4 2 2	1 3 5 5	3
Smooth-ly glide,	*smooth-ly glide,*	*on the si-lent*	*tide.*

G7	G7	C	C
D D D D	**D E F**	**E E E E**	**E F G**
2 2 2 2	2 3 4	3 3 3 3	3 4 5
Let the winds and	*wa-ters be*	*min-gled with our*	*mel-o-dy;*

C	G7	C	C
G E E	**F D D**	**C E G E**	**C**
5 3 3	4 2 2	1 3 5 3	1
Sing and float,	*sing and float,*	*in our lit-tle*	*boat.*

- *From C to G7 only two fingers move (E to F, C to B): great for practising smooth changes.*